

The Empty Seat

Genre: Drama

Age Range: 16-25

Characters

NIA (20) - Student returning after a traumatic absence.

JORDAN (21) - Classmate unsure how to reconnect.

Scene Description

Nia returns to class after weeks away. Jordan tries to reconnect, but Nia is emotionally distant and unsure how to exist in the same space again.

JORDAN: That seat's been empty for a long time.

NIA: I noticed.

JORDAN: People didn't know if you were coming back.

NIA: I didn't either.

JORDAN: I tried texting.

NIA: I saw them.

JORDAN: You never replied.

NIA: I couldn't.

JORDAN: Or you didn't want to?

NIA: Those are different questions.

(Beat)

JORDAN: I'm glad you're back.

NIA: Don't say that like I'm the same person.

JORDAN: I didn't mean it like that.

NIA: Then what did you mean?

JORDAN: That I missed you.

NIA: You missed an idea of me.

JORDAN: That's not fair.

NIA: Neither is what happened.

(Beat)

JORDAN: Do you want me to leave you alone?

NIA: I don't know.

JORDAN: That's honest.

NIA: That's all I've got right now.

JORDAN: I'm not going anywhere.

NIA: That might make things harder.

JORDAN: I can handle that.

NIA: You don't know that.

JORDAN: Then teach me.

NIA: I don't know how to be around people anymore.

JORDAN: Then we figure it out slowly.

(Beat)

NIA: Don't expect me to be who I was.

JORDAN: I'm not.

BLACKOUT